Why Your Website Matters: Six Reasons

Understand the job a website should do - and when a simple site is enough.

What you will take away

Turn your website from an online address into a useful place for customers to understand, evaluate and contact your business.

Start with this quick check

- Write down the question customers ask most often before buying.

- Check whether your current online presence answers it clearly.

- Decide the one action your website should help a visitor complete.

A website is not automatically better than a well-run booking profile or social account. Invest when it solves a real gap; keep tools that already work.

What to check - and why it matters

01 Give customers a place you control

Your own domain gives you a stable destination to share across listings, referrals and printed materials. Keep access to the domain, hosting and important content in the business's control; arrange backups and clear ownership terms.

02 Make your offer easier to understand

Explain services, suitability, service area and the difference between your options. Answer the questions people actually ask rather than adding filler for search engines. Google recommends helpful, reliable, people-first content. [1]

03 Help customers evaluate your credibility

Bring genuine work, team information, business details and customer feedback together. Make evidence easy to inspect. Never present sample designs, illustrative results or invented testimonials as real client outcomes.

04 Give searchers relevant information

Useful service pages and accurate business information help people and search engines understand your offer. A website can support discovery alongside your Business Profile, but it does not guarantee rankings, traffic or enquiries. [2,3]

05 Support enquiries beyond opening hours

Let people read information and request contact when the shop or office is closed. Explain whether a form is a request or a confirmed booking and when someone should expect a reply. Do not promise instant support unless you provide it.

06 Learn which actions matter

Record meaningful outcomes such as completed lead forms or confirmed bookings where your tools permit it. A click is not necessarily a lead, and a lead is not a sale. Review useful enquiries and business outcomes, not traffic alone. [4]

Your practical action plan

DEFINE - Choose a customer task

Pick a main outcome: request a quote, book an appointment, check suitability or call during opening hours.

BUILD - Start with the minimum useful content

A clear homepage, useful service details, credible evidence and a working contact route may be enough. Add pages when they answer a genuine question.

REVIEW - Check the return against the full cost

Include build, hosting, domain renewal, care, your time and any booking tools. Review qualified leads and completed work; do not attribute every sale to the website.

Illustrative example: a local gardener keeps social media for recent project photos and uses a small website to explain services, coverage, quotation steps and examples of completed work. Social posts link to the relevant service page rather than a generic homepage.

Make the next step specific

Main customer and question to answer:

One primary action for the website:

Content and evidence already available:

Budget, ongoing owner and review date:

Discuss your next step with Joseph

Tell Joseph what you do, who you serve and what customers need to do online. Start with the simplest scope that supports that goal.

Start a conversation with Joseph

Research notes and further reading

[1] Google: People-first content

[2] Google: SEO Starter Guide

[3] Google: Improve your local ranking

[4] Google Analytics: Conversions and key events

Research checked 25 October 2026. Examples are illustrative, not measured client results. Educational guidance, not a full technical, accessibility or legal audit.